[METRIC]
A-A-2892A
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Superseding
A-A-2892
November 16, 1994

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION
PAD, WRITING

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description for all federal agencies.

1. **SCOPE.** This description covers writing pads in three sizes.

2. **CLASSIFICATION.** Writing pad covered by this Commercial Item Description shall be of the following types, as specified.

Type: I 12.7 x 20.3 cm (5 x 8 inch)
II 21.6 x 29.8 cm (8 1/2 x 11 3/4 inch)
III 21.6 x 35.6 cm (8 1/2 x 14 inch)

3. **SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.**

3.1 Materials. The paper shall be white, and made from not less than 95% bleached chemical pulp.

3.2 Physical Requirements of Paper. The paper shall conform to the physical requirements of Table I.

Table I

Characteristic	Requirement	TAPPI Test Method
Basis Weight (17X22-500) Avg. g/m^2 (lbs.). +/- 5%	60 (16)	T410
Bursting strength, kpa avg., min. (psi)	83 (12)	T403
Thickness, mm +/- 0.12 mm (inch, +/- 0.0005 inch)	0.076 (0.0030)	T411
Opacity, percent, min.	75	T425

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Engineering Branch, 26 Federal Plaza, New York, NY 10278.

FSC 7530

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3.2.1 Writing quality. The paper shall be sufficiently sized to accept fountain pen ink writing without feathering or ink penetration through to the opposite side of the sheet when tested as follows. Draw several lines and characters on both surfaces of the paper with a medium point (commercial type) fountain pen using a one percent aqueous solution of Acid Red 1 Color Index Number 18050 or Acid Green 3 Color Index Number 42085. The Acid Red 1 or the Acid Green 3 may be obtained from Pylam products, International Dyestuffs Corp., Sandoz, Incorporated and Ciba-Geigy Chemical Corp. The lines and characters shall not feather or penetrate through to the opposite side of the paper. Both surfaces of the pad paper shall be sized or otherwise processed to provide good erasability. Good reasability of the paper surface shall be determined as follows. Draw several lines and characters with a No. 2 1/2 lead pencil and erase with a latex rubber eraser; on the same area, redraw pencil lines or characters and erase. The tested area shall not show smearing of the pencil lines, or failure of the paper fiber.

3.2.2 Color. The color of the sheets shall be white and all the sheets in a pad shall be the same color.

3.3 Backing. The pad backing shall be chipboard or other suitable paperboard which shall conform to Table II.

Table II

Characteristic	Requirement	TAPPI Test Method
Thickness, min. mm (inch)	0.48 (0.020)	T411
Bursting strength, avg. min. kpa (psi)	345 (50)	T807

3.4 Size. The pads shall be 7.6 cm x 12.7 cm (3" x 5"), 12.7 cm x 20.3 cm (5" x 8"), or 21.6 cm x 27.9 cm (8 1/2" x 11") as specified in the ordering data. A tolerance of +/-0.3 cm (+/- 1/8") in each direction shall be permitted. The first dimension given is the horizontal dimension.

3.5 Rulings. The sheets shall be ruled or unruled, as specified. Sizes 7.6 cm x 12.7 cm (3" x 5") and 12.7 cm x 20.3 cm (5" x 8") shall be unruled. Size 21.6 cm x 27.9 cm (8 1/2" x 11")shall be unruled, ruled one side or ruled two sides, as specified in the ordering data.

When specified, rulings shall conform to the following spacings:
For 21.6 cm x 27.9 cm (8 1/2" x 11") pads: Lines shall be spaced 0.8 cm (5/16") apart with a tolerance of +/- 0.1 cm (+/- 1/16"). The first line shall begin 3.5 cm (1 3/8"), plus 0.4 cm (3/16") or minus 0.3 cm (1/8"), from top edge of the paper. The unlined portion of the front and back sides of the sheet shall be located at the binding end of the sheet.

3.6 Ink. The ruling ink shall be blue color, continuous and uniform without waviness or feathering of the lines.

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3.7 Assembly of pads. Not less than one hundred sheets of paper and a backing sheet of equal size, +/- 0.1 cm (+/- 1/16") shall be securely fastened together along the top edge (horizontal dimension). Pads shall be fastened with a hot melt plastic resin material, or a cold water resistant, padding compound material, or an adhesive binding material with cheesecloth strip, at the option of the contractor, unless otherwise specified. Pads ruled on one side only shall be assembled with the ruled side uppermost.

3.7.1 Punching. When required, shall be punched as specified in the ordering data.

3.8 Padding strength. Hold the pad to be tested in a stationary, vertical position with the padded edge down. While holding the backing, allow the sheet pad to naturally fall until it hangs supported by the padding, without twisting or jerking the backing. Repeat the test three additional times. The pads of sheets shall not become detached from the pad backing nor separated for more than one inch along the padded edge.

3.9 Binding quality and strength. Remove five (5) sheets, one sheet at a time, from the pad and examine the torn edge of the sheets. The edge shall not be ripped with ragged edges, but shall have a clean and straight edge. Sheets shall be able to be removed with reasonable effort. Fold at least five (5) sheets over and under the pad and press the fold slightly. Examine the sheets and binding at the fold. The sheets shall not break, split, or separate from the binding of the pad.

3.10 Workmanship. All edges of the paper shall be smoothly and evenly cut. Paper shall be free from holes, tears, wrinkles, dirt, foreign matter, or other defects.

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENT. The contractor shall certify that the product offered shall contain a minimum of 20% postconsumer fiber as defined by the Paper Products Recovered Materials Advisory Notice (Paper RMAN) and the Executive Order 12995 dated March 25, 1996. The Paper RMAN is found in the Federal Register, Vol 61, Part IV dated May 29, 1996. The pad backing offered shall include a minimum of 90% postconsumer recovered materials, in accordance with CFR 40 part 250. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

4.1 Bleaching. To obtain an acceptable brightness, in accordance with the performance standards of this document, a chemical bleaching process may be used. When specified in the ordering data, the bleaching process shall not include the use of chlorine, chlorine dioxide, or other chlorine compounds. The Government reserves to right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

4.2 Labeling. The recycled content shall be marked on the product or unit pack.

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5. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS.

5.1 Product Conformance. The products provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this commercial item description. The quality of the product sold to the government shall be equal to or better than the quality of the product sold by the manufacturer in the commercial market. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

5.2 Testing. Testing shall be conducted in accordance with the referenced tests in the commercial Item Description. (Note: See TAPPI T400 for specific sampling instructions and acceptance criteria.)

6. PACKAGING, PACKING, LABELING AND MARKING. packaging, packing, labeling, and marking shall be specified in the contract or order.

7. NOTES.

7.1 Referenced Documents. The referenced documents in effect on the date of solicitation for offers or request for proposals shall be used to determine conformance with the requirements of this Commercial Item Description.

7.1.2 TAPPI test methods are available from: Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, P.O. Box 105113, Atlanta, GA 30348 (404) 209-7276.

7.1.3 The Final (Paper RMAN) is available from EPA'S public access server on the Internet or from the RCRA Hotline. The Hotline can be reached toll-free at (800) 424-9346.

Copy of Executive Order 12995 is available from:
The White House Publications Office, New Executive Office Building White House, Attn.: Publications, Washington DC. 20500, telephone (202)395-7332.

7.1.4 The Code of Federal Regulations, Title 40, Protection of Environment, Part 250 may be purchased from the Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402, phone(202)783-3238.

7.1.5 Copies of Commercial Item Descriptions, federal standards or specifications are available from: Federal Supply Service Bureau, Specification Section (3FPB-W), Suite 8100, 470 East L'Enfant Plaza, SW, Washington, DC 20407, phone (202)619-8925.

7.2 Ordering Data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

1. Title, number and date of the Commercial Item Description

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2. Size and Color

3. Ruled or unruled

4. Punching, if requested

5. Non-Chlorine bleaching is required

6. Specific, Packaging, Packing, Marking and Palletization.

8. LIST OF NSNs.

7530-00-239-8479 7530-01-124-5660 7530-01-131-0091

7530-00-285-3090 7530-01-131-1889

MILITARY INTERESTS:

NONE: DOD has no registered interest in revisions and amendments to this Commercial Item Description until further notice.

Preparing Activity:

GSA-FSS

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